

What's coming, and what's open

Forward pipeline only — what is announced, filed or approved but not yet built, and where a structural engineer is not on public record. Everything here is sourced and dated. Revised 26 August 2026.

+7.4% headcount in six months

Dallas — two roles, no Texas office

OCVIBE: 13 consultants, none structural

8 questions to ask

× ONE RULE BEFORE THE MEETING, AND ONE BEFORE THE ROOM

"Not publicly named" does not mean the seat is open. It means no public record names a structural engineer. Every line here is a reason to ask a question, never a reason to assert one.

And this document is yours, not theirs. Section 5 names the engineers who already hold MVE's work. That is preparation, so you never ask about a filled seat — it is not something to say aloud, and one of those names must not be said at all. See section 6.

QUESTION ONE

Are they getting busy? Yes — and here is the number

The clearest public measure is how often a new MVE project surfaces in the Los Angeles development press: **one in all of 2024, two in 2025, and four in the first eight months of 2026** — plus three LA projects in active construction. That is what Dan means.

The headcount says the same thing, and says it more precisely: they are growing, and the growth is speeding up.

WINDOW	HEADCOUNT GROWTH	WHAT IT MEANS
Six months	+7.4%	The recent half-year added more than the half before it
Twelve months	+5.2%	—
Twenty-four months	+14.8%	Steady underlying growth

Estimated headcount around 120. **Eight roles are advertised right now** — read from their own ADP portal and LinkedIn, last seen 25 August: an HR Manager, a Project Lead and a Project Manager in Irvine, a Job Captain in Los Angeles, a BIM Coordinator in Guadalajara, and two for Dallas. An earlier “~20 roles” figure came from a job aggregator and is not supported by the primary feed.

▲ DALLAS IS THE FRESHEST THING IN THIS BRIEF

A **Project Lead** and a **Job Captain**, both advertised for “*Remote — Dallas, Texas*” on **21 August 2026** — five days ago. **MVE has no Texas office**. Hiring a project lead and a job captain into a market where you have no studio is what a firm looks like when it is staffing a project there or standing one up. It is in no trade press. Ask about it.

Orange County billings rose 25% to \$28.1M in 2025 (OCBJ), and they hold **#8 in Orange County** and **#14 in Los Angeles County** (\$24.5M LA billings, 2025 — LABJ 2026). Two senior non-design hires this year: a Director of Marketing & Strategy in March, and their first General Counsel in July. The HR Manager opening is the third — a firm putting its scaffolding in.

Five offices, settled from their own contact page (read 26 August): Irvine, Los Angeles, San Diego, San Francisco, and **Guadalajara, Mexico**. Four California studios and one in Mexico — **no US office outside California**, which is what makes Dallas interesting. Denver, opened 2022, is not listed; there is no closure announcement and none should be assumed.

× THE EXCEPTION — SAN DIEGO IS NOT BUSY YET

Rongé’s studio opened with 10 staff, and the only two projects he has ever publicly named as its work are 4002 Park Blvd and The Becker — one in framing, one in plan check. **Not one of the eight open roles is in San Diego**. His 15–20 target lands around January 2027. Congratulating them on San Diego’s momentum would be a misread.

Who is in the room

The people who matter for a structural conversation, and what each one decides.

NAME	TITLE	WHY THEY MATTER HERE
Matthew McLarand, AIA NCARB	President + Director of Design, Irvine	Your contact, and why the meeting exists. Design-led rather than technology-led. He is not the one who will interrogate an architecture.
Pieter Berger, AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of Design, Irvine / OC	The structural-selection voice on Orange County work. If OCVIBE comes up, this is who knows the answer.
Chase Rongé, AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of San Diego	Runs the studio with no publicly named engineer on any of its work. ⚠ Ex-Carrier Johnson — see section 6.
David Arnold	Director of Finance and Operations, Irvine	With no IT function, finance-and-operations is the software-decision seat. He owns Deltek and will recognise every screen in a financials demo.
Daniel Gura	Director of Business Development, Irvine	Deal-flow gatekeeper. Present for relationship reasons.
Kenneth Nilmeier	Principal + Director of Planning, Irvine	25-year staffer. On a \$4B master plan, not a minor name.
Luis Arambula, NCARB	Principal + VP of Architecture, Irvine	Production leadership — the closest published thing to a delivery-and-standards owner.
Charles Pigg	Director of Business Development, Utah	Salt Lake. New geography for them.
Janet Dennerline	General Counsel, Irvine	Joined July 2026 — their first. ⚠ The most likely person to ask about data handling.

► THE STRUCTURAL FACT BEHIND ALL OF IT

MVE has no internal IT department — zero staff in IT, data science, product management and HR, against 27 in arts and design. That is why an HR Manager is being advertised now, and it is why anything requiring MVE to build, host or maintain software is a non-starter. ⚠ **Never point out that they have no IT department.** If the “what happens when you leave?” question comes up, it is common ground — two firms with the same constraint — never a jab.

QUESTION TWO

Where the structural seat looks genuinely open

Ranked by *stage* × *size* × *how little is locked*. The top row changed on 26 August, on the strength of a document filed with the City of Anaheim.

#	PROJECT	WHERE · CLIENT	SIZE	STAGE	STRUCTURAL
1	OCVIBE Residential Phase I	Anaheim · H&S Ventures	530 u	Final Site Plan filed 10/2025, NOD 02/2026	Thirteen consultants named in the filed directory. Structural is not one of them
2	Santa Clara Park (2518 Mission College)	Santa Clara · The Irvine Company	1,792 u · 2.85M sf	Council-approved 03/2025. Start waits on the leases in the dozen offices it replaces	not publicly named — landscape and civil are
3	Legacy Park	Mesa, AZ · Vestar / Pacific Proving	2,500 u · 750 keys	Entitlement ahead, groundbreak 2027	not publicly named
4	6201 Residences	Culver City · RCB / REDA	846 u	Approved 10/2025, start targeted 2026	not publicly named
5	Riverwalk at Studio City	Los Angeles · Genton / RC / Torino	814 u	Approved 06/2026, construction late 2027	not publicly named
6	5350 Wilshire	Los Angeles · Onni	419 u · 46 st	Draft EIR 30 July 2026 — freshest filing found	not publicly named
7	Mosaic	Long Beach · Turnbridge / Waterford	628 of 900 unbuilt	Entitled	not publicly named
8	Belhaven	Salt Lake City · Blox Ventures	1,497 u, 84 delivered	Phased	not publicly named

▲ WHY OCVIBE IS NOW FIRST

The entitlement set MVE's client filed with Anaheim in October 2025 carries a full project directory. It names the applicant, the agent, **smith-clementi** as master plan architect, **MVE + Partners as architect**, Fletcher Studio for landscape, Fuscoe for civil, Pirzadeh for traffic, Hunsaker for master planning, Holmes for the fire master plan, 3d-identity for signage, Moran for dry utilities, Water Concern for irrigation — and **NMG Geotechnical**. Thirteen disciplines, geotechnical among them, and **no structural engineer listed. John A. Martin & Associates does not appear.**

A final site plan does not always require the structural consultant to be named, so this is not proof of an open seat. But it is the closest thing in this brief to one, and it also confirms MVE's role from a city record rather than from their own website.

Also live and unlocked: the **Silos Hotel** (~150 keys) and three Silos retail buildings in Salt Lake, **Copper Hollow** in Layton, **Granary Square Phases II–IV**, **Downtown Daybreak** later phases, and **Gateway Crossings Phases 2 and 3** (~925–1,065 units plus a 225-key hotel, entitled, not started).

QUESTION THREE

What to enquire about — announced work with no architect yet named

► AVALONBAY IS BEING TAKEN OVER

It signed a merger agreement with **Equity Residential on 20 May 2026** — 2.793 EQR shares per AvalonBay share, former AvalonBay holders 51% of the combined company, closing expected in the second half of 2026, a new company name and dual headquarters in Chicago and Arlington. AvalonBay is a confirmed MVE client. **What happens to a development pipeline through a merger of that size is the most useful thing to ask them about**, and it is public and uncontroversial.

- **AvalonBay's forward pipeline is 31 communities and 9,997 apartment homes** — that is the entire public disclosure. Their quarterly supplemental names every community *under construction* and none of the ones that are not. The four Californian ones are all already started, so all locked.
- **AVA Pacific Beach** — AvalonBay, **138 apartments** plus two parking structures on their own Ingraham Street site, **approved by San Diego City Council 23 February 2026**, not started, no architect publicly named.
- **The Plaza** — The Irvine Company, 552 units, San Diego.
- **Jamison's four Koreatown / Westlake conversions** — ~1,086 units, no architect named on any.

- **Holland Partner Group’s 380 Inverness (Denver) and Ballard (Seattle)** — past site plan, no architect reported. Holland is a repeat MVE client.
- **Riverwalk San Diego’s remaining ~240 affordable units** — no developer or architect announced.
- **Riverwalk Phase 2+ — 17 of 20 parcels still undesigned**, and still not sequenced anywhere public: the site’s own news feed has published nothing since the Q2 2026 update. MVE holds master planning and entitlements for the whole thing.
- **Hines’ 276 for-sale townhomes at Riverwalk** — at grading, **architect not publicly named, so do not assume it is MVE.**

Kennedy Wilson / Toll Brothers — asked and answered, as far as the record goes.
The “29 sites, \$3.6B” figure is the September 2025 announcement. Kennedy Wilson’s own filings restate what actually closed: **24 land-position purchase agreements with potential capitalisation of ~\$2.9B**, in staggered closings from December 2025 to January 2026. Their 10-K and 10-Q name only two development projects anywhere, both in the Mountain West. The site list is not published and there is no sign it will be — which makes it a good question to ask rather than a gap to keep researching.

QUESTION FOUR · PREPARATION ONLY

Who already holds the structural work

So you never ask about a filled seat. ⚠ These are names to know, not names to say — and the first one must not be said at all.

ENGINEER	WHERE
🚫 The Vancouver firm — see section 6	Ritz-Carlton Residences Newport Beach; 3rd & Fairfax, Los Angeles. Never say this name.
Englekirk → WSP	Rafferty, Avalon West Hollywood, two executive-architect jobs. englekirk.com now redirects to wsp.com
Nelson Structural	Gateway Crossings Phase 1
DCI Engineers	Residences at Pacific City
SCA / NA & Associates	One Museum Square
Dunn Associates	Post District, Salt Lake
BHB Structural	The Silos, Salt Lake
Thornton Tomasetti	Seraph, Salt Lake (Hines)
John A. Martin & Associates	OCVIBE — at district level. They are not in the residential project directory

Salt Lake structural is locally held. That is a market-entry problem, not an open seat.

San Diego is the exception, and it is now a three-pass finding. No structural engineer is publicly named on *any* MVE San Diego project — not Riverwalk, not The Becker, not 4002 Park. On The Becker the developer, the architect, the contractor and the completion date are all published and the engineer is not. That is an absence of publication, and it is why question 5 below is worth asking plainly.

▲ IF THE CONVERSATION TURNS TO HOW WE WOULD ACTUALLY WORK TOGETHER

They run **Revit, Navisworks, Autodesk BIM 360 and Rhino** — and **Delttek**, the same ERP we do. Model exchange with them is a solved problem, not something either side would have to build.

READ THIS TWICE ON THE PLANE

Do not raise

× THE THREE THAT MATTER MOST – THESE ARE ABOUT US, NOT THEM

- **Never say “Glottman Simpson”, and never let a screen say it.** A fellow Vancouver firm holds at least two MVE structural seats, and KOR’s own written strategy names displacing them on MVE’s next OC high-rise as the number one play. None of that can be named, or typed into a search box.
- **MVE sits in KOR’s own BD database as a ranked pursuit target**, with real staff email addresses, a reconstructed org chart, and a report subtitled “Warm-intro priority list.” **Omit the BD module entirely.** The mitigating fact, if it ever surfaces: there are zero displacement briefs, zero pursuits and zero engagements against MVE. Nothing derogatory is stored. The exposure is that they would see themselves catalogued alongside their competitors.
- **The BD workspace’s default landing screen leaks other architects’ names with strategy attached**, with no click at all — 25 named architecture firms with a displacement column, and 12 named rival engineers. **MVE is an architecture firm.** Do not open it.

× AND THESE

- **Never type** MVE, McLarand, Glotman, Englekirk, WSP, Nelson, Carrier Johnson or JWDA into any search box in the suite. Each one lands on a screen from this list.
- **Chase Rongé is ex-Carrier Johnson**, and KOR holds displacement briefs on Carrier Johnson and on JWDA, both San Diego. **Do not open any San Diego architect dossier.**
- **The Operations repository, and any file dialog near it.** This document lives in it, and so does one naming Matthew as your personal contact.
- **MVE's revenue — do not state a figure, even a flattering one.** Sources disagree and none is a filing.

And these are project facts — safe to know, wrong to raise as live work.

- **Discovery Park is not MVE's.** The Irvine Company's 1,858-unit Irvine entitlement is **BDE Architecture's** — every architectural sheet in the plan set filed with the City of Irvine carries their title block. BDE is a San Francisco multifamily firm **with a San Diego office**. On their largest new entitlement, MVE's oldest client chose someone else.
- **4002 Park Blvd (Pali) — the structural seat is not open.** San Diego's permit record shows a building permit in plan check (\$47.1M, 21 storeys, 206 units) and **an ACI 318-19 code-deviation request issued in May 2024** — a structural submittal. An engineer has been engaged for over two years. It is also not stalled: gas services were cut in June 2025, the undergrounding permit has been in inspection since October 2025, and grading agreements issued on 30 June and 9 July 2026. It has not started vertical construction. It is not dormant either.
- **Park Summit is a different building** — a 21-storey tower on Balboa Park's northwest corner, opened July 2026, JWDA architect. Easy to confuse with 4002 Park Blvd. It is not MVE's.
- **Snug Harbor, Newport Beach** — the General Plan Amendment was **rescinded 6–0 on 9 February 2026** after a referendum. It is dead.
- **Reserve at Silo Park — broke ground 14 October 2025.** Two developer websites still describe it as pre-development.
- **The Village at Riverwalk** (721 units) and **Riverwalk Central Village — Gensler**, not MVE.
- **9th & Broadway / Celadon** — completed 2015, and two other firms also claim it.
- **Uptown Newport** — not an Irvine Company project. Shopoff Management.
- **350 Fig and 920 S. La Brea** — entitled but dormant since 2020 and 2024.

- **Terrence Seah**, previously the San Francisco studio director, no longer appears and has no listed replacement. **Do not mention him.**

THE ASK

The questions, in order

The first is asked before you travel. The rest are asked in the first ten minutes, neutrally and casually.

1 Before the trip To Matthew or Daniel Gura: “Who should I make sure is in the room?” Framed as courtesy, it determines the running order more than anything else here — and nobody has asked it.	2 The opener “What’s taking you to Dallas?” Two roles advertised for Texas on 21 August, no Texas office. Five days old, in no trade press, and a question about their ambitions rather than their consultants. If the answer is a project, ask who is engineering it.	3 The real one “Who is doing structure on the OCVIBE residential buildings?” 530 units, MVE as architect on the filed drawings, thirteen consultants named including geotechnical, and no structural engineer among them. Ask Pieter Berger, not David Arnold.
#	ASK	WHY
4	“What has to happen before Santa Clara Park starts?”	1,792 units approved eighteen months ago. The public answer is that the Irvine Company is waiting out the leases on the offices it replaces. Landscape and civil are engaged; structural is not on record.
5	“How are you covering structural in San Diego and Salt Lake?”	No structural engineer is publicly named on any MVE San Diego project across three passes, and Salt Lake is locally held. Asked neutrally, this is the question.
6	“How is the Sa cap in the 2026 code landing on your podium plates?”	⚠ Ask a design principal, not Arnold. This is the question that makes KOR sound like the engineer they should hire rather than the vendor they are being shown. Their live problem, our lane, and it needs no software at all.
7	“What does the Equity Residential merger do to AvalonBay’s pipeline?”	A client of theirs is being absorbed into a company half again its size, closing this half of the year.
8	“What came out of the Toll Brothers transition to Kennedy Wilson?”	24 land positions, ~\$2.9B, unpublished. They will know what they kept.

► IF THE SOFTWARE DEMO HAPPENS, THESE FIVE CHANGE WHAT YOU SHOW

- **“You’re on Deltek — is that Vantagepoint or Ajera? And have you switched Ask Dela on?”** Dela is off by default. If it is on, they will benchmark you against it in real time.
- **“What are you filing project email into today — and do you run Deltek PIM?”** This reshapes the first two segments.
- **“Who looks after your IT and your Revit deployment — in-house or someone you bring in?”** The highest-value unknown. Zero internal IT staff and no provider identified. That person is the most likely source of technical pushback, and asking tells you who is missing from the room.
- **“What Revit version are you standardised on, and do you publish a BIM execution plan or CAD standard?”** $\triangle$ Directly load-bearing for DXF→ETABS, whose layer contract has never been run on a foreign set.
- **“Are you on Bluebeam — and are you on Max?”** If yes, they have Smart Overlay in preview. Pitch rebar on the steel-weight delta, never on the change list.

HONESTY

What is not established

No revenue figure is given here. Published sources disagree and none is a filing; the commercial database that supplied the growth percentages also carries a ~\$39M revenue estimate, and an estimate is not a number to quote at a client. The billings above are local, and labelled as such. The headcount figures are estimates too — it is the *direction and the acceleration* that carry the argument, not the absolute number.

× ONE ERROR THAT KEEPS PROPAGATING

That same database describes MVE as having **aviation work and projects in Egypt**. They have neither. Both claims were checked to exhaustion — zero matches across 74 live pages, ~140 archived pages and ~4,700 archived URLs. Directory blurbs repeat it. Do not let it into the room.

Still blocked: Culver City's project pages and Santa Clara's planning directory refuse even a browser request, so 6201 Residences and Santa Clara Park could not be read from their own city records.

KOR Structural — MVE + Partners forward-pipeline brief. Revised 26 August 2026. Confidential; prepared for Jim.
Backing detail in the MVE company profile and the demo dossier.

Where a structural engineer is **not publicly named**, that means no public record names one. It does not mean the seat is open.